vegetables, many of whom were forced to sell their produce for a pittance or watch it rot before their eyes.

As a consequence, despite a bumper harvest, farmers across the country were unable to pay their farm labour or repay their loans. They could not buy agricultural seeds or fertilizers for the sowing season of the winter rabi crop. As a consequence, not only land-owning farmers but also landless agricultural labour and migrant workers, dependent on agriculture, were rendered destitute.

The stories below are an indicative sample of the widespread distress faced by 65 per cent of India's population, who depend on agriculture for their livelihood.

- The price of tomatoes at Girnare mandi near Nashik, Maharashtra dropped to as low as 50 paise per kg, making it impossible for farmers to recover the investments they made while sowing. Faced with the alarming fall in the price of tomatoes, Yashwant and Hirabai Bendkule, a poor adivasi couple, were forced to destroy their crops because keeping them standing would result in a greater loss.[15]
- 'Because farmers living in remote villages face a huge problem of walking long distances to reach a bank to exchange their higher denomination notes, some middlemen take their notes at a value discounted by 20 to 30 per cent,' says Udit Sahu, in-charge of a Customer Service Point in Dungriput village of Koraput district, Odisha. 'The situation with farmers who have sold their kharif harvest is all the more dire because they all have invalid ₹500 and ₹1,000 notes in cash. They are not able to avail the limited exchange facility because the banks ask the farmers for documents like Aadhar or PAN card, which most of the tribal and backward farmers of Kandhamal district do not have… Local cooperative societies and the district cooperative banks do not accept the old currency notes. And many of the farmers do not have accounts with nationalised banks to deposit the cash